



HIRE driver japan · Academy

Day 1, the VVIP standard

VVIP Service Training · Instructor's Programme

OCTOBER 2026 EDITION

For instructors and staff. Not for distribution to trainees.

What the VVIP standard means

GOALS

- Explain who VVIP clients are and what they expect.
- State the difference between good service and the VVIP standard.

MANDATORY RULES

The priorities, always in this order: safety, confidentiality, comfort, professional conduct.

The driver is invisible: present the moment they are needed, unnoticed the rest of the time.

The ideal ride: the client arrives safely and on time, undisturbed, free to work or rest, never forced into conversation.

TEACHING NOTES

Open by handing out Appendix D, the expectations written by a real client's office, and say so: trainees then see the rules as a market requirement, not the instructor's taste.

Prepare two examples of a small slip that loses the next booking (a scent, a delay with no message).

EXERCISE

Each trainee names one reason a client never came back; the group sorts them under the four priorities.

COMMON MISTAKES

Believing service means entertaining the client. For VVIPs, quiet is the service.

Western and Middle Eastern clients

GOALS

- Know how expectations differ by culture and avoid offence.
- Make it a habit to confirm the unknown with the assistant beforehand.

MANDATORY RULES

Western clients: handshake and eye contact, Mr. or Ms. plus surname. Punctual; they want to hear about a delay before the reason.

Personal space: no touching, no standing too close. Even with luggage, ask first.

Middle East: prayer times, halal, Ramadan, customs on men and women sharing a car or shaking hands. A male driver never offers a handshake to a female client.

Confirm customs with the assistant in advance, through dispatch, never with the client.

Never judge by nationality. When unsure, choose the more formal and more discreet option.

TEACHING NOTES

Wealthy Gulf clients place particular weight on an invisible driver and a silent cabin. Rules 2 (conversation) and 5 (smell) in Appendix D say exactly that.

EXERCISE

Hand out three profiles (a US executive, a Saudi family, a French couple); each team writes the five questions to ask the assistant in advance.

COMMON MISTAKES

Asking 'Where are you from?' as friendly small talk. Personal questions are forbidden.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 3

Driver preparation: grooming, odours, kit

GOALS

- Bring yourself to five-star standard before every job.

MANDATORY RULES

The driver is scent-free. No perfume, cologne, strongly scented fabric softener or scented hair products.

No smoking before or during a job: it stays on clothes and in the car.

No strong-smelling food (garlic, onion, curry, fried food) before or during a job. No eating or chewing gum in the car on duty.

Check breath and hands: brush teeth, use a mint and wash hands before the job.

Dress: dark suit, white shirt, quiet tie, polished shoes. No creases, stains, sportswear, flashy watches or jewellery.

Hair, beard and nails neat. Arrive rested and well.

Phone on silent. No personal calls or phone use while on duty, except in an emergency.

Kit: licence, itinerary, contact sheet, name board, umbrella, a spare shirt, mints, two handkerchiefs.

TEACHING NOTES

People cannot smell themselves. Recommend asking a family member or colleague.

Define scent-free concretely: nothing beyond clean soap.

EXERCISE

Trainees check each other with Appendix A and each names one thing to fix.

COMMON MISTAKES

Thinking a little perfume is fine. In a closed cabin, a little is strong.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 4

Vehicle preparation: checks, cleaning, odours, airing, temperature

GOALS

- Have the vehicle completely ready before the client steps in.
- Control cabin odour and temperature yourself.

MANDATORY RULES

Technical check: fuel or charge sufficient; tyres, lights, wipers, washer fluid and air conditioning working.

Exterior washed, wheels and glass clean. Interior: seats, footwells, door pockets, inside glass, mirrors and boot. Fingerprints, hair and grit are noticed.

The cabin is scent-free. No air fresheners, scented sprays, tobacco or food smells. Use unscented cleaning products.

No eating or drinking in the car. No food brought into the cabin, apart from the minibar stock.

Airing: while the client is away, open the windows every 15 minutes. Always air the cabin once before the client boards.

Temperature: set the cabin to 23°C at least ten minutes before boarding, or to the client's stated preference. Hold 23°C during the ride; change it only when the client asks.

Music, radio and satnav voice off. Sound only when the client asks for it.

The driver's personal items (drinks, bags, papers, chargers) out of the client's sight, not even on the front seat.

Clean before every job and tick Appendix B.

TEACHING NOTES

'Every 15 minutes' is a concrete number for drivers who lose track of time on their phones while waiting. Have them use a timer.

23°C is a figure actually specified by a client's office (Appendix D, rule 4).

Put a thermometer in the cabin and show the gap between the display and the real temperature.

EXERCISE

On the morning of day 3 each trainee prepares their vehicle to Appendix B; the instructor checks glass and seat gaps by hand.

COMMON MISTAKES

Using an air freshener to make it 'smell nice'. The target is no smell, not a nice smell.

Starting the engine and leaving at once, so the cabin is hot or cold when the client boards.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 5

Minibar and amenities

GOALS

- Stock the standard amenities in the right place and condition.

MANDATORY RULES

Standard minibar: still water (room temperature and chilled), canned or bottled tea and coffee, soft drinks, chocolates and candies, orange-scented refreshing towels (chilled).

Amenities: tissues, wet wipes, charging cables (USB-C and Lightning), two umbrellas, a blanket, mints, a phone stand, a travel adaptor, a first-aid kit, a rubbish bag.

Drinks unopened, labels facing forward, lined up. Check use-by dates before every job.

Within the client's reach. Mention once after boarding: 'There is water and a charging cable here, please help yourself.'

Offer the towel on boarding: chilled in summer, warm in winter.

Restock after every job; anything used is replaced before the next client.

TEACHING NOTES

Lay the full sample kit on a table and have trainees arrange it correctly. Let them photograph it to reproduce at the depot.

Canned or bottled Japanese tea and coffee are fine; never serve hot drinks in the car because of scalding risk.

EXERCISE

Set up a vehicle minibar from scratch in five minutes, timed by the instructor.

COMMON MISTAKES

Keeping drinks in the boot. Out of reach, they do not exist.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 6

The name board

GOALS

- Greet correctly at airports and hotels while protecting the client.

MANDATORY RULES

White board, bold black printed letters, A4. No handwriting, no marks. Company or brand logo small.

Normal clients: Mr. or Ms. plus surname. Never the full name.

Clients with security, public figures: never the real name. Use a code name or signal agreed with the assistant. A real name reveals where they are.

Hold it at chest height, with both hands, straight. Never while looking at a phone.

Stand where the exit is visible without blocking the flow. Never call out in front of the exit.

In position 30 minutes before arrival; check the flight for delays and report to dispatch.

TEACHING NOTES

Show two samples: a correct one (Mr. Smith) and a wrong one (full name and company in large letters).

EXERCISE

From three client profiles, trainees decide what each name board should say.

COMMON MISTAKES

Writing the full name and flight number for anyone to read.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 7

Preparing the itinerary

GOALS

- Read the operating plan and prepare the itinerary completely before the job.

MANDATORY RULES

Receive the itinerary the day before and check times, places, companions, language and special instructions. Ask dispatch about anything unclear, the day before.

Check pickup and drop-off points in advance. Visit new places if possible; at the least, check entrances, forecourts and stopping points on the map.

Prepare a main route and an alternative. Check traffic and weather on the morning of the job.

Buffers: arrive 30 minutes before a pickup; estimate journeys at 20% more than the usual time.

Decide waiting spots and parking in advance. Never sit for long at a main entrance.

Carry the contact sheet (dispatch, assistant, security lead) on paper as well. A dead battery is no excuse.

Changes during the job: contact dispatch and get approval before acting.

TEACHING NOTES

Teach clearly here that the driver works under the company's instructions. Trainees do not need the legal theory; the habit 'even if the assistant tells me directly, dispatch first' is tested.

EXERCISE

Hand out a real one-day itinerary with a hotel and an airport; trainees add buffers, alternative routes and waiting spots.

COMMON MISTAKES

Relying on the satnav with no alternative. The moment traffic stops, there are no options.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 8

Greeting, doors, seating, luggage, rain

GOALS

- Perform the sequence from greeting to boarding safely and gracefully.
- Handle rain and a client with shopping.

MANDATORY RULES

The first words: introduce yourself, welcome them, guide them to luggage and car. That is enough.

Open the door only when fully stopped and after checking behind and around; walk round, hand on the frame, warn about the roof edge. Close gently and fully after checking hands, feet and clothing.

Confirm seating in advance. If unknown, gesture to the rear seats and let the client choose.

The driver loads and unloads. Ask whether the client wants to keep a bag of valuables with them.

Shopping bags: never let the client carry them. Say 'Let me take those', load them in the boot or where the client prefers so they cannot tip over, and ask whether fragile items should stay with the client.

Rain: have the umbrella open before the client leaves the building. The umbrella covers the client; the driver may get wet. Walk beside the client to the car, or to the next cover. Open the door first, then close the umbrella. Same on arrival.

Two large black umbrellas: one for the client, one for a companion.

Drop-off: announce 'We will arrive in one minute', open the door after stopping, check for items left behind.

TEACHING NOTES

This chapter is the first scenario on day 3. For the rain scenario, make them do it for real; a watering can or hose is not excessive.

Demonstrate the umbrella angle: tilted towards the driver so the client's shoulders stay dry.

EXERCISE

In the car park, each trainee performs greeting to boarding to drop-off; the others score with Appendix A.

COMMON MISTAKES

Holding the umbrella so the driver stays dry.

Watching the client board with their own shopping bags.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 9

Conduct in the car: do not initiate

GOALS

- Understand and practise silence as a service.

MANDATORY RULES

Never start a conversation unless the client does. No small talk, personal stories or unnecessary questions.

If the client starts a conversation, answer politely, briefly and professionally. No personal questions. Opinions and advice only when clearly asked.

Never comment on the client's calls, meetings, schedule, mood or private matters.

The driver may only speak about safety, the arrival announcement, changes of plan and traffic that changes the timing. Conclusion and time first, in one sentence.

Never interrupt a call or work. Tell them at arrival if needed.

Do not turn round to the client. Phone on silent and untouched. No eating, no gum.

Drive smoothly: no sudden braking, acceleration, lane changes or speeding. Smooth enough for the client to read.

Keep a professional distance. Do not try to build rapport.

TEACHING NOTES

Many Japanese taxi drivers were taught that silence is rude. State the opposite standard clearly here; reading rules 2, 9 and 12 of Appendix D aloud works well.

Practise 'one sentence': traffic, route change and arrival announcement, each in 15 words or fewer.

EXERCISE

A 30-minute mock ride with the instructor as client (chairs will do). The instructor takes a call, reads papers and asks one question. Note when the trainee should and should not speak.

COMMON MISTAKES

Unable to bear silence, starting on the weather or sightseeing.

DAY 1 · CHAPTER 10

Confidentiality and social media

GOALS

- Explain what confidentiality covers and what is dangerous on social media.

MANDATORY RULES

Everything seen or heard on duty is confidential: names, destinations, times, companions, conversations, calls, documents in the car.

Tell no one: family, friends, colleagues, other clients, social media. Leaving out the name is not enough.

No photos, videos or recordings of any kind: not the client, the cabin, the car outside the hotel or the destination. No posting, even afterwards.

No location data, location tags or live streaming on duty.

Never ask a famous client for an autograph or selfie. If asked to take a photo, only on the client's device.

Never read documents in the car. Keep lost items unopened under company procedure and report at once.

If the press or anyone asks, say only 'I cannot comment' and report to the company. The duty continues after the job.

TEACHING NOTES

Prepare three examples of posts that look harmless (a hotel forecourt photo, 'drove someone famous today', a luxury car with a timestamp).

EXERCISE

Show the three posts; trainees explain who could identify the client from each.

COMMON MISTAKES

'It's fine without the name.' Car, place and time identify the client.

Working with assistants, security and family offices

GOALS

- Know whose instructions to follow and to whom to report.

MANDATORY RULES

The driver works under the company's instructions. Itinerary changes go through dispatch.

Assistants: advance information comes through the company; small updates during the job, such as departure times, may come directly.

Security: the security lead decides routes, stopping points and the order of getting in and out. Never change route on your own.

Family offices: detailed instructions such as school runs and activities. Take notes and repeat back.

Report start, end, delays and anything unexpected to the company, briefly and precisely.

TEACHING NOTES

Security rides are practised in scenario 3 on day 3. Here, write the order on the board, such as never getting out before security to open the door.

EXERCISE

Act out the assistant adding a destination mid-ride; the trainee performs the correct steps (call dispatch for approval).

COMMON MISTAKES

Following the assistant's instruction on the spot, meaning well, and not telling the company.

The unexpected

GOALS

- Act calmly: safety, communication, then alternatives.

MANDATORY RULES

Delays: as soon as known, tell the assistant and the company with a new arrival time. Reason short, with an apology.

Illness: stop safely, check consciousness and breathing; call 119 if needed, then the assistant and the company.

Accidents: secure the client, call 110 and the company. Onward travel is arranged through the company.

Vehicle fault: stop safely, call the company for a replacement. Tell the client briefly what is happening and what happens next.

Changes of plan: get dispatch approval before acting.

Lost items: keep unopened, tell the company and the assistant at once.

In every case: stay calm, inform the client briefly and clearly, offer a practical solution, add no stress.

TEACHING NOTES

Have them memorise the emergency numbers (110, 119, 118) and the company's emergency line.

EXERCISE

Draw a card (traffic, illness, puncture, added destination) and state the first three actions within 30 seconds.

COMMON MISTAKES

Calling once the delay is certain. Call the moment it becomes likely.